

Prateek Newsletter Vol. I (2025/26) — Comprehensive Audit

Reviewed against: **UN Disability Inclusive Language Guidelines (2021)**, **WHO/APA guidance on ageing language**, **NCDJ Disability Style Guide (2018)**, **WCAG 2.2 AA**, and general editorial standards.

Severity key: ● Critical (fix before circulation) • ● Important • ● Polish • ●
Accessibility of the document itself

Now the remaining issues.

● Critical issues (fix before any wider circulation)

1. "Disabilties" misspelled twice on page 5

The Divisions page (printed page 5, AIDA section) has:

- "AIDA: AI for People with **Disabilties**" (heading)
- "International Conference on AI for People with **disabilties** in Nepal" (objectives sidebar)

Both should be "**Disabilities**" / "**Disabilities**" (and capitalised in the heading).

2. AIDA logo and acronym still use singular "Disability"

The newsletter is inconsistent:

- ✓ Founder's message: "AI for People with Disabilities"
- ✓ AIDA About page: "AI for People with Disabilities"
- ✗ **AIDA logo** (every appearance): "AI FOR PEOPLE WITH DISABILITY"
- ✗ Divisions page heading: "AI for People with Disabilties" (typo + singular intent)

The UN standard is **plural** — "**persons with disabilities**" — because disability is not a single condition but a diverse set of lived experiences. From the UN Disability Inclusive Language Guidelines: "we recommend using people-first language in United Nations websites, documents and speech, with the term 'persons with disabilities'".

Action: Update the AIDA logo to read **"AI FOR PEOPLE WITH DISABILITIES"** and standardise the plural form everywhere.

3. Name spelling mismatches across pages

Two team members are spelled differently in their bio vs. their testimonial:

Team page (8–9)	Testimonial page
PRIJMA DAHAL (Research Intern)	PRISHMA DAHAL (page 16)
SMRITI GAIRHE (Research and Grants Coordinator)	SMRITI GAIHRE (page 19)

Pick the correct spelling for each person (ask them) and apply it everywhere including filenames and social posts.

4. "Prateek Innovation" (singular) in testimonials

The organisation name is **Prateek Innovations** (plural), but two testimonials use the singular:

- Prishma Dahal's testimonial (page 16): "My experience at **Prateek Innovation...**"
- Shreeya Tamang's testimonial (page 17): "an AI Research Intern at **Prateek Innovation**" and "with **Prateek Innovation** in the future."

Fix to **Prateek Innovations** in both.

5. Internal contradiction: "Nepal's first" vs "South Asia's only"

- Founder's message (page 1): AIDA is described as **"South Asia's only AI and Assitive Technology Integrated Hackathon"**
- AIDA division page (page 5): described as **"Nepal's first national level hackathon"**

These don't contradict literally, but they confuse the reader on positioning. Pick one anchor claim and use it consistently. If both are true, the founder's framing is the stronger external pitch; consider: *"Nepal's first national-level hackathon dedicated to AI for people with disabilities — and the only such integrated hackathon in South Asia."*

UN / WHO / NCDJ compliance gaps

These are the substantive language issues against the published standards.

6. "The elderly" / "Elderly Care" — fails UN and WHO/APA

The term "**elderly**" has been formally rejected by the UN since 1995 and is flagged as biased by APA, WHO Healthy Ageing materials, and most current geriatric style guides. "Terms such as 'older persons,' 'older people,' 'older adults,' 'older patients,' 'older individuals,' 'persons 65 years and older,' and 'the older population' are preferred. Avoid using terms such as 'seniors,' 'elderly,' 'the aged,' 'aging dependents,' and similar 'othering' terms because they connote a stereotype". This is reinforced in geriatric medicine literature: "In 1995, the United Nations Committee on Economic Social and Cultural Rights of Older Persons rejected the term elderly in preference for the term older persons".

The newsletter uses "elderly" four times:

Where	Current	Replace with
Founder's message (p.1)	"persons with disabilities and the elderly continue to face barriers"	"persons with disabilities and older persons continue to face barriers"
Founder's message (p.1)	"International Conference on AI for People with Disabilities and Elderly Care in 2028"	"International Conference on AI for Persons with Disabilities and Care for Older Persons in 2028"
Divisions / PINN (p.4)	"AI companions and technologies for elderly care and social interaction"	"AI companions and technologies for the care of older persons and social interaction" — or " ageing-in-place support "
Centre name (p.4)	"Centre for Companion & Care Technologies"	(already neutral — keep)

This is the **largest single compliance issue** in the document — same word, four hits, settled UN terminology for 30 years.

7. "Assistive AI for Autism" — fails NCDJ for autistic community

Page 21, theme 2: "**Assistive AI for Autism.**"

NCDJ and the autistic self-advocacy community (ASAN, Autistic Self Advocacy Network) prefer **identity-first language** — "autistic people" — and frame interventions as *with* the community, not *for* the condition. "AI for autism" reads as treating autism as the thing to be solved.

Fix: "Assistive AI for the Autistic Community" or "Inclusive AI with Autistic Individuals."

The latter also aligns with your own "Built With, Not For" core value.

8. "Deaf community" capitalisation inconsistent — fails NCDJ

NCDJ and the World Federation of the Deaf use **capital-D "Deaf"** for the cultural-linguistic community, lowercase "deaf" only for the audiological condition. "When referring to a person or people who identify as part of this community, cap up the D in Deaf. If in doubt, write 'd/Deaf'".

-  Project description (p.14): "in close collaboration with the **Deaf community**" — correct
-  Keynote page (p.22): "directly serves the **deaf community**" — should be capital D

9. "Non-hearing communities" — non-standard

Project description (p.14): "bridges the communication gap between hearing and **non-hearing** communities."

"Non-hearing" isn't a recognised term in the community or in any major style guide. Use **"Deaf and hard-of-hearing communities"** or **"hearing and Deaf communities."**

10. "Blind aids" — clinical and dated

Centre for Human Mobility (p.4): "physical aids and systems including Sign Language Translation platforms, **blind aids**, and advanced prosthetics."

Fix: "Sign Language Translation platforms, **assistive technologies for blind and low-vision users**, and advanced prosthetics."

11. "Speech-Impaired individuals" — acceptable but dated

AIDA theme 4 (p.21): "AI-Powered Education for Deaf and **Speech-Impaired** individuals."

Current preference is **"non-speaking individuals"** or **"people with speech disabilities"** — both centre the person rather than the deficit.

12. "Empowering Lives through AI" — paternalism flag

AIDA cover page tagline. The UN guidance and disability self-advocates increasingly push back on **"empower"** as a framing word because it positions the abled actor as the source of power being granted to disabled recipients. The CRPD frames things in terms of **rights, equal participation, and barrier removal.**

The phrase isn't outright wrong, but consider:

- "AI that removes barriers"
- "AI for equal participation"
- "Accessible AI for an inclusive society"

Your own tagline "AI for Accessible Innovations" is already stronger than "Empowering Lives."

13. "AI solutions FOR people with disabilities" — at odds with your own value

Repeated phrasing throughout: "AI-powered solutions for people with disabilities." This contradicts your own "**Built With, Not For**" core value.

Selective rewordings:

- "AI solutions **co-created with** people with disabilities"
- "AI solutions **addressing barriers identified by** people with disabilities"
- "AI solutions **developed alongside** the communities they serve"

Use these mainly on the AIDA About page and the AIDA cover subtitle. You don't need to scrub every instance — just demonstrate the value once or twice prominently.

14. "TEAMS WITH PERSON WITH DISABILITY AS A PARTICIPANT" — awkward + singular

AIDA In Numbers (p.26). Reads as a grammar tangle.

Fix: "Teams with at least one participant with a disability" or "Teams including a participant with a disability."

Editorial polish

15. Trainers & Mentors page duplicates two people

Page 23 lists **Suvasini Shrestha** and **Jatin Bhusal** twice each. This was almost certainly because each person filled two roles, but the layout doesn't make that clear — it looks like a duplication mistake.

Fix: consolidate each person to one card and list both roles ("Founder & CEO, Prateek Innovations • Lead Mentor"). Or split the page into separate "Trainers" and "Mentors" subsections with a clear heading on each.

16. AIDA 2025 Winners — no project descriptions

Page 25 lists Team Think AI (Winner), Mission Chaurasi (1st Runner Up), Access Code (2nd Runner Up), Synaptic (Best Innovation) — but says **nothing about what any of them built**. For a flagship event recap, this is a missed opportunity. One line per team minimum:

Team Think AI — [solution name]: [one-line description of what it does and which AIDA theme it addressed].

Ask the four teams for a one-sentence description each. This page becomes much more compelling.

17. AIDA Keynote — photo dominates, content thin

Page 22: Dr. Modi's photo takes roughly 60% of the page; the actual content of his talk is a small block. Either crop the photo smaller or add **2–3 specific takeaways** from his keynote (e.g., "Discussed the role of large vision-language models in continuous sign recognition" / "Demonstrated the iSign dataset and its applications").

18. British / American spelling mixed

- "ORGANISED" (British) on page 6 — "Events Organised"
- "ORGANIZATION" (American) on page 26 — "Female Organization Committee"

Pick **one variant** (British is the more common choice for Nepal-based organisations) and apply throughout. While you're there, "Female Organization Committee" is also slightly off as a label — see #20 below.

19. Honorifics applied inconsistently

The AIDA Team/Jury pages mix "Mr." / "Mr" / "Ms." / "Ms" / "Mrs." / "Dr." Pick one style and apply uniformly. Modern editorial convention: drop honorifics entirely unless required (e.g., "Dr." for genuine doctorates only).

Also: "**Mr. Dhruba**" on the Jury page should be "**Mr. Dhruba Adhikari**" (his card is missing the surname while everyone else's is complete).

20. AIDA In Numbers — stat labels need polishing

- **"81% FEMALE ORGANIZATION COMMITTEE"** — should be **"81% female representation on organising committee"** or **"Organising committee: 81% women"**.
- **"40% FEMALE PARTICIPATION"** — fine, but pair with a denominator if you have it ("40% of 125 teams").
- **"4 TEAMS WITH PERSON WITH DISABILITY AS A PARTICIPANT"** — see #14 above. Also worth noting: 4 of 125 $\approx$ 3%. For an accessibility-focused hackathon this is honest to report but worth pairing with intent for AIDA 2026 ("growing this to 10% by 2026" or similar).

21. "TOP 13 ICT AWARDS 2023" still ambiguous

The giant "13" sits in the same visual hierarchy as 3 papers / 2 projects / 16 team members / 2 events, but it actually means "we were top-13 finalists." A 2023 award in a 2025/26 newsletter also feels stale unless framed as historical.

Fix: Reformat as **"Top 13 Finalist • ICT Awards 2023"** on one line, in smaller type than the other stats, or move it to a "Recognition" sidebar.

22. "SEMI FINALE" should be "SEMI-FINALS"

Jury page (p.24). "Finale" means an ending; the semi-finals are not endings. Use **"Semi-Finals"** (and consider hyphenating "Grand Finale" — already correct).

23. The "Mission" section isn't a mission statement

Page 3 lists five fragments under "MISSION": Research with Purpose / Build for Impact / Empower Through Inclusion / Lead Ethically and Openly / From Nepal to the World.

These are **strategic pillars or guiding principles**, not a mission statement. Either:

- **Relabel** them as "Strategic Pillars" or "Guiding Principles," or
- **Write a proper one-sentence mission**, e.g.:

To advance assistive technology research and inclusive innovation from Nepal to the world, building tools alongside the communities they serve.

24. Founder's message — italicised body is hard to read

The entire ~300-word founder's message is set in italics, justified, over a faint watermark. Italics work for short emphasis, not for long body copy. The result is the **hardest-to-read page in the newsletter — and the most important one.**

Fix: Set body in roman (non-italic), left-align (or enable hyphenation if you must justify), and reduce the watermark opacity behind text. Italicise only the closing line ("let's build that future together") if you want emphasis. Apply the same fix to all italicised testimonial and project description blocks.

25. Moments page (p.7) — no captions

A wall of photos with no context. Add a one-line caption under each ("*AIDA 2025 Grand Finale — Kathmandu, [Month] 2025*", "*Workshop on accessibility design, [date]*"). This is invaluable for **screen-reader users** specifically, and makes the page meaningful for everyone else.

26. Cover lacks tagline and issue date

The "AI for Accessible Innovations" tagline appears on page 2 but not on the cover. Add it in smaller type under "VOL. I." Add an issue month (e.g., "May 2026") so future readers can date the publication — important for an annual.

Accessibility of the document itself

UN Disability Inclusion Strategy indicator 15 treats document accessibility as part of communications compliance. Your Canva-exported PDF likely fails on several of these:

27. Alt text on every image

Every photo, logo, and infographic icon must have an alt-text description, or screen readers skip them entirely. In Canva: ensure "Tagged PDF" is enabled on export, then verify in Adobe Acrobat → Tags panel. The Moments page, team headshots, and partner-logo grid are the highest priorities.

28. Reading order tags

Canva's PDF export often gets reading order wrong (sidebars get read first, or photos get read mid-sentence). Open the export in Acrobat → Reading Order tool and verify the flow.

29. Colour contrast — likely fails WCAG 2.2 AA in places

The small "VOL. I | PRATEEK 2025/26" header at the top of every page (light teal on cream) and some of the lighter teal subheadings are at risk of failing the 4.5:1 minimum for normal text. Run them through a contrast checker (WebAIM or Adobe Color). If they fail, either darken the teal or increase the type size to large-text thresholds (3:1).

30. File size

The reviewed file is large for a 32-page A4 PDF; for an accessibility-focused organisation, a heavy file is itself an access barrier on slow connections. Export as "**PDF Standard**" rather than "PDF Print" in Canva, or run the final export through Adobe's compressor / Smallpdf to land under 10 MB.

31. Plain-language summary / Easy Read version

UN guidance recommends an **Easy Read** version for cognitive accessibility. For a flagship document of an accessibility organisation, this is worth doing — a 1–2 page plain-language summary alongside the full PDF, hosted on your website.

32. Alternative format

Offer the newsletter as **plain HTML on prateekinnovations.com** in addition to the PDF. HTML is more reliably accessible than any PDF export, and search engines can index the content (SEO bonus).

Structural gaps

33. No "What's Next" / roadmap section

The newsletter ends with Thank You → Contacts. There's no forward-looking page that says: what is Prateek aiming to do in 2026? When is AIDA 2026 opening registration? What grants or partnerships are you actively seeking? When does the planned 2028 conference open its call for papers?

Adding a one-page "**Roadmap 2026 → 2028**" between Thank You and Contacts would give partners and potential collaborators a clear ask.

34. No representation note on disability inclusion within the team

For an organisation whose mission is built on the principle of "Built With, Not For," the team and alumni pages don't visibly flag any persons with disabilities. This is a sensitive observation — I'd frame it externally only as "we're actively working on this" rather than as a public self-critique. But internally, for AIDA 2026 and for the team itself, it's worth a deliberate plan: outreach, reserved internship slots, or visible inclusion in leadership roles.



Drop-in replacement table (copy-paste fixes)

Find (current text)	Replace with
Disabilties (typo, 2 places)	Disabilities
the elderly	older persons
Elderly Care / elderly care	Care for Older Persons / the care of older persons
Specially abled	Persons with disabilities
AI for People with Disability (logo + headings)	AI for People with Disabilities
Assistive AI for Autism	Assistive AI for the Autistic Community
the deaf community (cultural sense)	the Deaf community
non-hearing communities	Deaf and hard-of-hearing communities
blind aids	assistive technologies for blind and low-vision users
Speech-Impaired individuals	non-speaking individuals
Empowering Lives through AI	Accessible AI for an inclusive society (or similar)
Prateek Innovation (singular, in testimonials)	Prateek Innovations
TEAMS WITH PERSON WITH DISABILITY AS A PARTICIPANT	Teams with at least one participant with a disability
SEMI FINALE	SEMI-FINALS
Mr. Dhruba (Jury page)	Mr. Dhruba Adhikari
LEAPFORG (already fixed)	LEAPFROG ✓

ACCROSS / COMITTEE / PARTICIPTION
(already fixed)

ACROSS / COMMITTEE / PARTICIPATION 

Overall assessment

The newsletter's **intent and framing are right** — rights-based, "Built With Not For," accessibility-first, research-grounded. The remaining issues are mostly:

1. **Inherited terminology** ("elderly," singular "Disability," "blind aids") — mechanical find-and-replace.
2. **Inconsistency** (name spellings, British/American, capitalisation) — careful sweep.
3. **Document accessibility** (tags, alt text, file size) — re-export with Tagged PDF + Acrobat pass.
4. **Two structural additions** (project descriptions for AIDA winners, a Roadmap page) that would significantly strengthen Vol. I.

None of these are hard. All are worth doing before this gets wider distribution — and especially before you send it to any UN, INGO, or international academic partner, who *will* notice the terminology immediately.

If useful, I can next draft any of the following as ready-to-paste copy:

- A corrected one-sentence mission statement
- A rewritten Founder's Message with all language fixes applied
- A revised AIDA 2025 Winners page with project descriptions (you give me the team summaries, I'll write them)
- A new "Roadmap 2026 → 2028" page
- A plain-language Easy Read 1-pager summarising the whole newsletter